

B1 Personal Progression

06 May 2026 16:38

Personal Progression

You should explore a range of career opportunities, produce valuable materials and demonstrate specialist skills relating to your goals for personal progression.

B1.1 Inform ideas for progression into a creative career

• The Industry

I would like to work within the creative technology and interactive media industry, particularly in a role where creative design and programming are combined. I am interested in developing digital products and experiences where both the visual design and technical development contribute to the finished project. This could include roles such as a web developer, front-end developer, creative developer, interactive media developer or, potentially, a game developer.

I am interested in this industry because I enjoy the process of taking an idea and turning it into something that can actually be used or experienced. I particularly like projects where I can make creative decisions while also solving technical problems. This is one of the reasons I have enjoyed studying Creative iMedia and learning programming alongside it. My current skills include using Visual Studio Code, HTML, CSS and JavaScript, as well as creative software such as Adobe Photoshop and Illustrator. I am also interested in expanding my knowledge of other software and programming languages as my career develops.

- Another reason I am interested in this industry is the variety of work available. Rather than completing exactly the same task every day, creative technology projects can involve designing, programming, testing, communicating with clients and solving problems. I would particularly like a role where I can work as part of a team while also having opportunities to communicate with clients and understand their requirements.

• Jobs and Roles

There are several careers that could suit my interests. A front-end developer would focus on creating the visual and interactive parts of websites and applications using technologies such as HTML, CSS and JavaScript.

- A creative developer combines programming with creative design to produce interactive digital experiences.
- An interactive media developer can work on websites, applications, games and other digital experiences.
- A game developer would use programming and creative skills to develop games and interactive environments.

At this stage, I do not want to restrict myself to one specific job title. Instead, I want to develop a combination of creative and technical skills so that I can decide which area suits me best after gaining more experience.

• Employment Opportunities

There are several ways of working within this industry. A person can work as a permanent employee for a creative agency, technology company, game studio or other organisation. This would provide the opportunity to work as part of a team on larger projects.

- Freelance work is another option. A freelancer can work directly with clients and be paid for individual projects rather than being permanently employed by one company. This provides greater independence but also requires the freelancer to find clients, manage deadlines, communicate professionally and manage their own finances.
- Self-employment could also allow me to establish my own creative business in the future. However, I would first want to gain experience working for an organisation or completing smaller freelance projects before considering this as my main source of income.

• My Progression Aims

My short-term goal is to successfully complete Year 13 and achieve or exceed my predicted grades, including my target of D*D*D in Creative iMedia. I also want to continue developing my HTML, CSS and JavaScript skills through my coursework and personal projects.

- My medium-term goal is to progress into higher education or an apprenticeship related to computing, web development, interactive media or another course that combines technical and creative skills. During this stage, I want to build a portfolio containing several different projects that demonstrate both my creative and technical abilities.
- My long-term goal is to gain employment in a creative technology or interactive development role. I would like to progress from an entry-level position into a more experienced role where I can take greater responsibility for projects, communicate with clients and potentially lead parts of the creative or technical development process.

• Industry Demand

The creative technology industry continues to develop as organisations increasingly depend on websites, applications, digital content and interactive experiences. However, competition for entry-level positions can be high, particularly because employers can expect junior applicants to have relevant qualifications, technical skills, portfolios and practical experience.

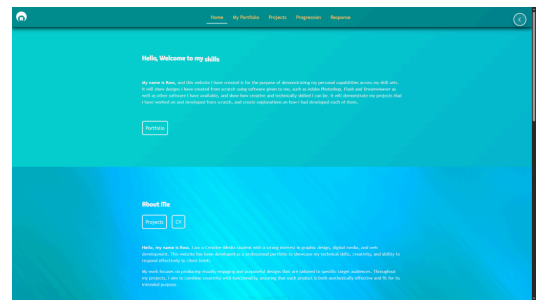
- Artificial intelligence is also changing the industry, since AI tools can automate or assist with some entry-level tasks, meaning that simply knowing how to produce basic code or designs may become less valuable. However, this also increases the importance of skills such as problem solving, creativity, communication, critical thinking and the ability to understand a client's requirements. I therefore believe that developing a combination of technical and creative skills will make me more adaptable as the industry changes.

I will need to continue learning throughout my career because software, programming languages and industry practices are constantly developing.

• Research into actual careers and employers

To make my career research more specific, I investigated actual employers, university courses and examples of people working in the industry rather than relying only on general career descriptions.

- One particularly relevant example is Saffron Interactive, which advertises graduate front-end development work involving HTML5, CSS3 and JavaScript. The role also involves working within a project team, contributing to solutions from the initial concept through to the finished design, and considering animation and visual quality. This is particularly relevant to me because it combines the two areas I am most interested in: programming and creative design. It suggests that my existing HTML, CSS and JavaScript knowledge provides a useful starting point, but that I would need to develop these skills to a professional level and become more confident working with larger projects.
- I also investigated games development as a possible career route. Examples of current games-development portfolios show that graduates often demonstrate practical experience with software such as Unity and programming languages such as C# or C++. They also use portfolios to demonstrate completed projects and technical skills rather than relying solely on their qualifications.
- This comparison has helped me identify an important difference between the two routes. Front-end and creative development are more closely connected to the skills I am currently developing through Creative iMedia, particularly HTML, CSS, JavaScript, interface design and visual communication. Games



- development is still an area I am interested in, but it would require me to learn additional specialist technologies such as a game engine and C# or C++.
- Therefore, at this stage I believe that front-end or creative development is my strongest primary career direction, while game development is a possible alternative route. I do not want to completely remove game development because my Year 13 game project is giving me useful programming, design, planning and problem-solving experience that could contribute to a future games portfolio.
- Research into higher education**

I have also compared courses that combine computing and creative skills. The University of Leicester's BSc Creative Computing requires BBB at A-level and specifically describes the value of having a combination of arts and sciences qualifications.

 - The University of Southampton's BSc Creative Computing has a standard entry requirement of BBC and considers the suitability of a portfolio for applicants.
 - Goldsmiths' BSc Creative Computing requires CCC and combines programming with areas including graphics, sound, creative AI and full-stack web development. It also offers an optional industry placement year.
 - I also researched apprenticeships as an alternative to university. One relevant example is the Level 4 Software Developer Apprenticeship with Collier Pickard in Sevenoaks. The role involves developing web applications using technologies including HTML, CSS, JavaScript and TypeScript, while also gaining experience with testing, debugging, Git and communicating with customers. This apprenticeship is relevant to me because it builds on my existing web development skills while providing professional workplace experience and a recognised qualification. However, it is more focused on software development than the Creative Computing degrees I researched, which offer more opportunities to explore areas such as graphics, sound and digital media. This means university may be more suitable if I want broader creative development, while the apprenticeship could be better if I want to gain direct software development experience.
 - These courses are particularly relevant to me because I currently study both Maths and Physics alongside Creative iMedia. This means I can demonstrate both technical and creative interests rather than having to choose completely between them.

Based on this research, I currently believe that a Creative Computing or similar degree is a strong potential route for me. However, I will continue comparing this with computing, software development and apprenticeship routes before making a final decision.

B1.2 Apply problem solving practice to develop a strategy for career progression

- Progressions aims**
 - My overall progression strategy is based on developing the skills and experience I need for a career in creative technology. My research in B1.1 has shown me that front-end or creative development is currently the strongest direction for me because it combines programming with creative design. However, I will continue developing transferable skills so that I can also consider related areas such as interactive media and game development.
 - My short-term goal is to successfully complete Year 13 while continuing to develop my programming, creative software and professional skills. I also want to produce a portfolio that demonstrates what I can actually create rather than relying only on qualifications. My Creative iMedia coursework and personal projects, particularly my interactive game, will provide evidence of my programming, interface design, planning, problem solving and creative development.
 - My medium-term goal is to progress into higher education or an apprenticeship. I am currently considering both routes rather than committing to one immediately. I will compare the entry requirements, course content, costs, application deadlines, opportunities for practical experience and progression opportunities of each route. I will then use this information to create a shortlist of suitable options and decide which route best matches my qualifications, skills and career aims.
 - My long-term goal is to establish a career in a creative technology role where I can combine design and programming. I currently believe that front-end or creative development is the most suitable direction for me, although the skills and experience I develop could also allow me to move into related areas later in my career.

- Work Experience**

←

Thank you!

Miss Wakefield, Mrs O'Connor, Miss Langley,

Thank you so much for letting me work with you for these last two weeks. I'll definitely remember this, as I had a great time with you and the students, and I'm glad I could be of help.

You didn't have to give such a gift to me, but I'll gratefully accept it.

If you ever need me for something, you can always contact me.

I hope you have a great long-weekend, and once again, thank you for having me.

Ross

EY

Early Years

To You

⋮

Hi Ross,

Thank you so much for your message. We all loved having you in Early Years and you are most welcome about the gift. I have found your spider today - so will give it to Hayley to pass on to you!

If you are ever at a loose end you would be most welcome to come back.

Miss Wakefield

- Applying for university courses or apprenticeships**

Hello Ross! You're doing great!

★

22nd

in year group

50% progress

(aim for at least 60% this year)

The University of Edinburgh

Graphic Design 4FT BA (Hons)

Add 2 applications

 or go back

Find an apprenticeship

Back

822 results found

Filter

Active filters

Clear filters

Where

SS6 (within 40 miles)

Create an alert for this search

Apply filters

What

Enter a job or company

Where

Enter a city or postcode

SS6 9JZ

Within

40 miles

Hide companies recruiting nationally

Show all sections

Sort results

Distance

New

Apprentice Payroll Administrator

PECUNIA PRO LIMITED
RAYLEIGH (SS6 7HH)

Distance 0.5 miles
Start date 1 October 2026
Training course Accounts or finance assistant (level 2)
Wage £13,520 a year

Closes in 14 days (Tuesday 22 September 2026 at 11:59pm)
Posted 8 September 2026

Data Apprentice

TAYLOR HAWKES LTD
Rayleigh (SS6 7UP)

Distance 1.3 miles
Start date 25 September 2026
Training course Data technician (level 3)
Wage £16,000 a year

Closes in 10 days (Friday 18 September 2026)
Posted 18 June 2026

Creating a personal statement



Personal statement

by Ross Thurgood

UK universities will see the statement broken up into 3 sections. However to see how the whole thing reads together, here it is as one block of text.

I want to study a creative engineering course to further my understanding of physical and digital skills, so that I can apply them in real world scenarios and learn more about them. It would greatly help any skill for a job and I could easily transfer my learnt skills to other topics. By doing this, my understanding of creative design will increase and I could be able to help others as according to the knowledge I would know.

My qualifications and education has provided and improved my combination of problem solving and creative skills. I have developed my capabilities to be able to plan out my outcome and work with or without planned steps and carrying out constant research to change and adapt to improve or counter any issue I come across, learning so that it can be avoided in future experiences. Using these skills I have been able to create and update an online portfolio available to be viewed publicly by any employer or admissions team. This also allowed me to learn how to code, giving me the ability to write in different languages to help improve the design of my site to make it unique and memorable compared to the millions of others online. I have developed the skill to process and visualise problems and solutions to help me understand and enhance my work to my best capability.

- This is a created draft of my personal statement, I will progress and develop this over my year in year 13 and will go through multiple drafts and redraws until I am happy. I will use the support of my teachers to help improve my statement to better fit my purpose and correct the areas that need progress.

Creating my professional CV

Ross Thurgood

+44 7472 289736 | thurgood.ross@outlook.com | rossthurgood.co.uk | github.com/rossthurgood | Rayleigh, Essex

PROFILE

A motivated sixth-form student at Sweeney Park School with a strong track record of leadership, creativity, and community engagement. Alongside A-Levels in Mathematics and Physics and a BTEC in Creative Media, I have served as a school prefect, technical director of multiple school musical productions, and a Scout leader-in-training. I am experienced in graphic design and web development, and I bring a disciplined, team-oriented approach to everything I take on.

EDUCATION

A-Levels & BTEC

Sweeney Park School Sixth Form, Rayleigh

Sept 2024 – Present

– A-Level Mathematics (predicted: C)

– A-Level Physics (predicted: D)

– BTEC Level 3 Creative Media Practice (predicted: 'Triple Distinction')

– Extended Project Qualification (EPQ) – Chemical Science (in progress)

– Note: A-Level predictions are early-year estimates and expected to improve.

GCSEs – 8 subjects

Sweeney Park School, Rayleigh

June 2025

– Mathematics – B

– Combined Science (Trilogy) – 7-7

– French – 6

– English Language – 6 (Spoken Language: Merit)

– English Literature – 5

– Drama – 5

– Geography – 4

– Cambridge National Creative Media – Merit at Level 2

SKILLS

Design & Digital Media

Adobe Photoshop (CSE), Dreamweaver, Flash, vector illustration, logo design, poster design, photo manipulation

Web Development

HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript — built and maintain personal portfolio site (rossthurgood.co.uk)

Core Competencies

Leadership, teamwork, public speaking, problem solving, planning, adaptability

Other

Piano (3 years formal lessons), basic first aid, compass & navigation (CofE expeditions)

WORK EXPERIENCE & VOLUNTEERING

Physics Subject Ambassador

Sweeney Park School

Sept 2025 – Present

– Represent the Physics department at internal and primary school outreach events.

– Assist younger year groups and primary pupils with science activities and demonstrations.

Young Leader in Scouting

8th Rayleigh Cub Scouts

Oct 2025 – Present

– Attend weekly Cub Scout meetings to plan and run activities for children aged 8-10.

– Support adult leaders and act as a positive role model for younger members.

Science Week Volunteer

Downhall Primary School, Rayleigh

March 2026

– Delivered hands-on science experiments to over 90 children across a full school day.

– Explained scientific concepts in an engaging and age-appropriate way.

Work Experience – Reception Class Teaching Assistant

Downhall Primary School, Rayleigh

Apr – May 2024

– Two-week full-time placement (09:05–16:00) supporting a class of 4–6-year-olds.

– Led play-based learning activities, assisted reading sessions and outdoor play, and managed daily classroom routines alongside the class teacher.

Primary School Sports Day Helper

Down Hall Primary School

June 2025

– Set up equipment, guided children between stations, and ensured events ran smoothly and safely.

Community Volunteer

Rayleigh Methodist Church

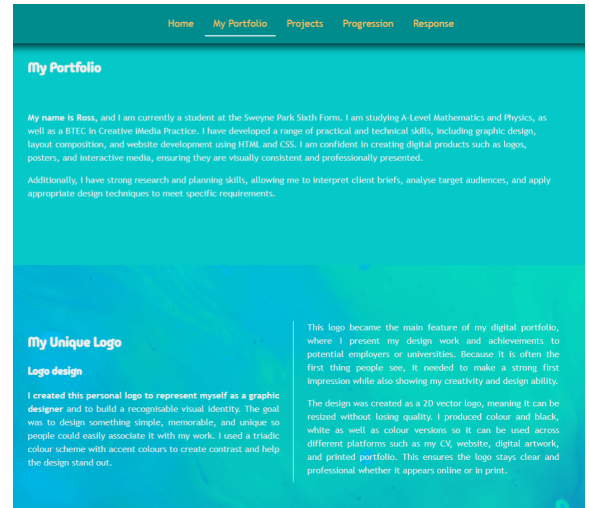
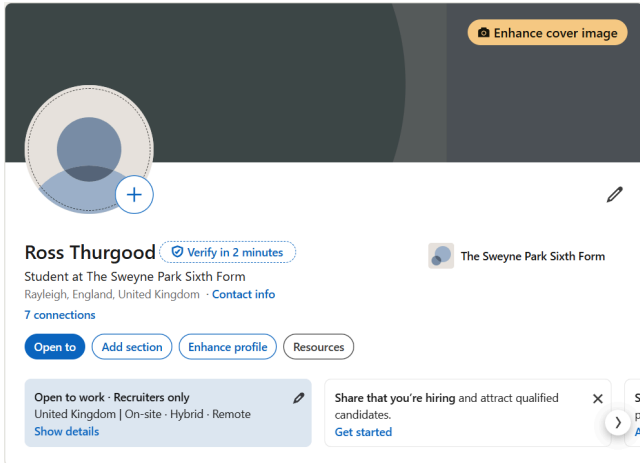
July 2019 – Sept 2023

– Supported community events, charity drives, and youth programmes over four years.

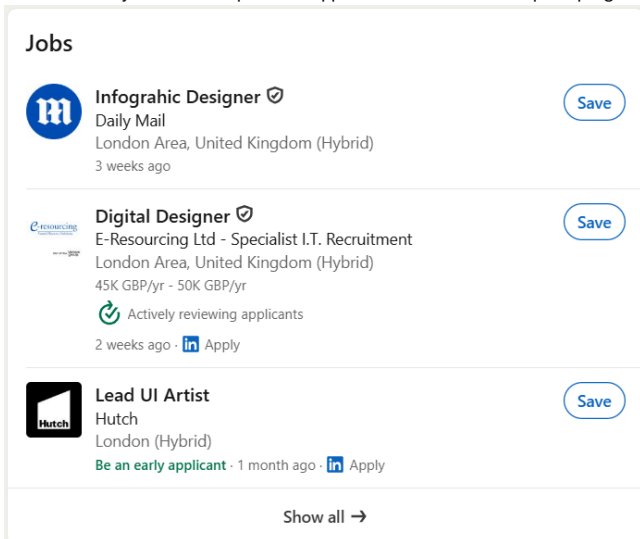
- When creating my CV, I looked at examples and guidance on what makes a CV clear, professional and suitable for employers. I considered the importance of including relevant information such as my

education, skills, work experience and achievements, while keeping the layout organised and easy to read. I also used feedback and advice I had previously received when creating CVs to improve the structure and presentation. I understand that a CV should be tailored to the specific job I am applying for, so I can highlight the skills and experience that are most relevant to each employer.

- **Creating a linked-in account**



- I created a LinkedIn profile to help me build an online professional presence and explore potential career opportunities. When setting up my profile, I included information about my education, skills, work experience and interests so that employers can get an overview of my background. I also looked at other LinkedIn profiles and considered what information would be useful to include on my own profile. I have identified creative careers that interest me, particularly roles involving coding and graphics design. Having a LinkedIn profile will allow me to keep track of my experience and achievements, follow companies and discover job or work experience opportunities that could help me progress towards a creative career.



- **Skills gap analysis**

My current skills give me a useful starting point, but my research into employers and careers has identified several areas that I need to develop before I can successfully enter the industry.

- My strongest current technical area is HTML, CSS and JavaScript. I have used these technologies in Creative iMedia and personal projects, including my Year 13 interactive game. However, professional roles require me to work on larger and more complex projects. I therefore need to improve my JavaScript knowledge, debugging ability, responsive web design and ability to organise larger codebases.
- I also need to improve my understanding of professional development practices. This includes using version control effectively, organising files and projects, documenting my work and becoming more familiar with the tools and technologies used by employers. I will develop these skills through practical projects rather than relying entirely on tutorials, as completing a working project provides stronger evidence of my ability to apply what I have learned.
- My creative skills are another area I need to develop. I have experience using Photoshop and Illustrator, but I want to become more confident when creating visual identities, interfaces and digital assets. My branding project and portfolio will allow me to practise these skills and demonstrate their development.
- I will measure my progress through the quality and complexity of completed work rather than simply recording how many tutorials I have completed. For example, successfully implementing a new feature in my game, creating a responsive website or producing a complete piece of branding would provide evidence that I have applied the skills I have learned.

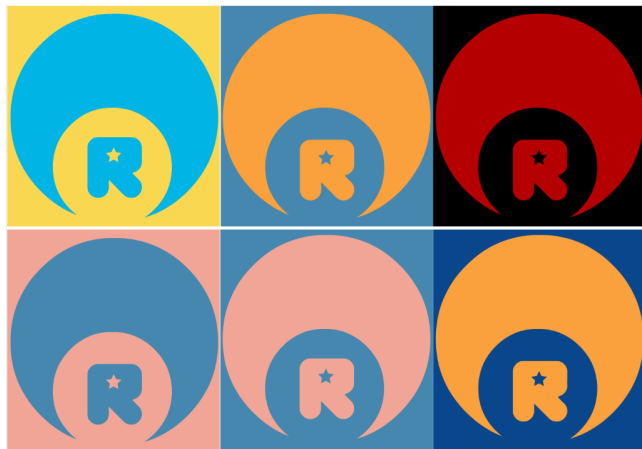
- **Progression strategy**

- To address these skills gaps, I will use a combination of online learning, coursework and personal projects. When I identify a weakness, I will research the relevant technique and then apply it to a practical project. This will allow me to identify problems, test solutions and evaluate the result.
- For programming, I will continue practising HTML, CSS and JavaScript while gradually increasing the complexity of my projects. My Year 13 game will be particularly useful because it requires me to solve problems involving game logic, user interfaces, interaction and organisation of code. I will document significant problems and the solutions I use so that I can demonstrate my problem-solving process.
- For creative development, I will continue using Photoshop and Illustrator and will complete practical design work to improve my understanding of layout, typography, branding and visual consistency. I will use feedback from teachers and other people reviewing my work to identify weaknesses and make further improvements.

You now need to create a brand identity for yourself. Your logo and branding will be used to personalise your own digital portfolio, where you will showcase your work ready for interviews.

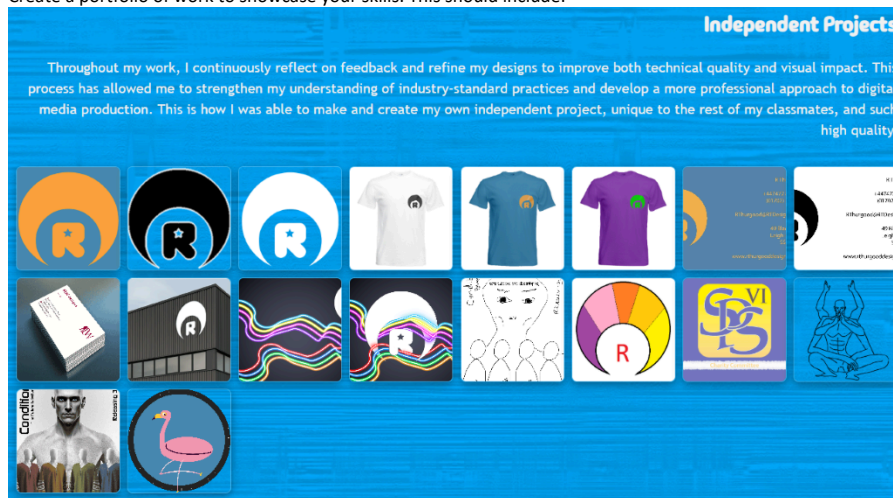
- **Creating my brand**

Ideas:



- **Creating my interview Portfolio**

Create a portfolio of work to showcase your skills. This should include:



- **Creating contact/business cards**





B1.4 Demonstrate professional practice & behaviours in relation to career aspirations

- During my time at both of my work experience placements, I regularly attended meetings and stayed after working hours when appropriate to help the staff. This allowed me to build positive working relationships with the people I was working with and showed that I was willing to take responsibility and contribute beyond the minimum tasks I was given. I was also given smaller independent tasks that I could complete myself, which helped reduce the workload of the people I was working under. I had to organise my own time and make sure these tasks were completed to the deadlines that had been set. This helped me develop my organisation and time management skills, as I had to plan my work around a schedule while still completing tasks to an appropriate standard. These experiences also helped me understand the importance of reliability and communication in a professional environment. Attending meetings regularly meant that I needed to listen to instructions, understand what was expected of me and communicate with other members of the team. When completing independent work, I was responsible for managing my own progress rather than relying on someone else to constantly supervise me.
- A specific example of time management is when I had to complete a debugging task in updating a software program, that needed doing before a meeting I was present in started. This was managed by creating a quick mini schedule of the steps I needed to complete before the deadline was due. Each step was detailed with an end goal and the time that the task should have taken, which allowed me to complete the fix of the software before I was needed elsewhere. This was successful time management that I am capable of using on a day to day basis to complete all of my tasks if needed.
- Overall, my work experience showed me that professional behaviour is not just about completing assigned tasks. Being reliable, organised, willing to take responsibility and able to work independently all contribute to building trust within a workplace. These are behaviours that I will continue to apply to my education, coursework and future employment.

B1.5 Apply communication skills to support progression into a creative career

• Mock Interview

- As part of my progression activities, I completed a mock interview to practise presenting myself in a professional situation. I was asked questions about the volunteering I had completed, my work experience placements and how I had contributed to the community. I was also asked why I believed I was a good candidate and what positions of responsibility I had held. The final question asked what three items I would take if I were stranded on an island, which tested how I could respond to an unexpected question rather than simply repeating prepared answers.
- The questions about my volunteering, work placements and positions of responsibility made me reflect on the experience I already have and how it demonstrates skills that could be useful to an employer. They also showed me that when discussing my experience, I should explain what I actually contributed and what I learned rather than simply listing the activities I have completed.
- The question about why I was a good candidate made me think about how I communicate my strengths and provide evidence to support them. I realised that it is more effective to connect a strength to a specific example from my experience rather than simply stating that I am organised, reliable or hardworking.
- The unexpected island question also showed me that an interview cannot always be predicted. I had to think about my answer without having prepared for the question, which helped me understand the importance of staying calm and communicating clearly when faced with something unexpected.

• Feedback and Reflection

- The feedback from my interview was that I took quite a long time to answer some questions. Although I was confident for my first interview, I did not always answer the specific question that had been asked. Instead, some of my answers moved into related topics. This showed me that being confident is useful, but I also need to make sure that I listen carefully to the question and structure my answer around it.
- I also tried to maintain good body language throughout the interview. However, when I was reminded to use a more relaxed posture, I became too relaxed and sank into my chair. This showed me that body language needs to appear natural rather than something I consciously change too much during an interview.
- Overall, the interview helped me identify both strengths and areas for improvement. I was able to communicate confidently despite it being my first interview, and I avoided making the entire conversation about myself. However, I need to improve the speed and relevance of my answers and become more comfortable maintaining professional body language throughout an interview.
- I will use this feedback when preparing for future progression opportunities. My personal statement is still a draft, so I will continue improving it throughout Year 13 and use what I have learned from the interview to make sure I communicate my experience and strengths clearly and directly. I also plan to review and update my CV next, particularly to ensure that my experience and skills are presented in a way that is

relevant to the opportunities I apply for. This will allow me to apply the feedback from the interview beyond interviews themselves and improve the way I present myself professionally.

- For future interviews, I will take a short amount of time to understand the question before answering, but avoid taking so long that my response becomes hesitant. I will aim to directly answer the question first and then support my answer with a relevant example. I will also try to maintain a professional but natural posture rather than consciously changing it too much during the interview.

- **Reflection**

- Completing these progression activities has helped me understand that progressing into a creative career requires more than developing technical and creative skills. I also need to be able to present myself professionally, communicate effectively and respond to feedback.
- Creating my CV and personal statement made me consider how I communicate my skills and experience to someone who does not already know me. Creating my LinkedIn profile also showed me the importance of maintaining a professional online presence. My work-experience communication gave me an opportunity to practise communicating professionally and taking responsibility for creating opportunities for myself.
- The mock interview provided the most direct opportunity to practise these skills in a realistic situation. The questions and feedback helped me identify areas where my interview technique could be improved. I used this experience to consider how I structure my answers, provide evidence from my own experience and communicate my skills more confidently.
- Overall, I have learned that progression materials should not be treated as finished after they have been created. They should be reviewed and improved when I receive feedback or gain new experience. I will therefore continue to update my CV, personal statement, LinkedIn profile and portfolio throughout Year 13 so that they accurately represent my current skills and are suitable for the opportunities I apply for.